

Hanna SisteK

September 29, 2026

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Academic Appointments

2026-2027	Postdoctoral Civil Discourse Fellow Edmond & Lily Safra Center for Ethics <i>Harvard University, Cambridge, MA</i>
2026-	Research Affiliate Governance and Responsible AI Lab (GRAIL) Student Perspectives on AI Research & Knowledge Lab (SPARK) John Martinson Honors College <i>Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i>
2025-2026	Postdoctoral Fellow Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology (CAPT) & Governance and Responsible AI Lab (GRAIL) <i>Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i>

Education

2025	Ph.D. Political Science <i>Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i> Major field: <i>Comparative Politics</i> Minor fields: <i>International Relations, Political Methodology</i> Dissertation: <i>Structural Incentives for Politicians to Manipulate Domestic Opinion</i> Committee Members: <i>Cherie D. Maestas (chair), Andy Baker, Mollie Cohen, Marcus Mann</i>
2021	M.A. Political Science <i>Purdue University, West Lafayette, IN</i>
2005	Journalism degree <i>University of Gothenburg, Sweden</i>
2003	B.S. Physical Therapy Exchange year, <i>University of Melbourne, Australia</i> <i>Lund University, Sweden</i>

Peer-Reviewed Publications

* indicates a graduate student co-author; † indicates an undergraduate student co-author.

- I. | Hannah, Matthew, Jennifer Hoewe, **Hanna SisteK**, Taeik Kim*, and Dan Goldwasser. 2024. "**A mindfulness-based information literacy framework for the current information environment.**" *Journal of Information Literacy*, 18(2).
[Named a Top 20 Article of 2024 by the Library Instruction Round Table of the American Library Association]

Working Papers

- I. | "Escalating Political Use of Disinformation: A New Reputational Theory Explaining Communication Changes in Democracies" *Under Review*.
2. | "Asymmetric Behavioral Shifts in Political Use of Disinformation: Case Study Interview Evidence From Europe"
3. | "Asymmetric Accountability: Affective Polarization and Public Responses to Political Disinformation".
2. | "Public Justifications of Political Disinformation in the United States: Comparing Manual Coding and Generative AI Classification" with Normand Péladeau and Priyadevi McNamara.

Works in Progress

- I. | "Using Large Language Models to practice cross-partisan dialogue" with Nebras Alam†, Netra Joshi†, Sarrah Zojwalla†, Vipula Shirse† and Daniel Schiff.
3. | "AI as a Tool Against Partisan Disinformation"
4. | "The Effect of Disinformation on Twittersphere Sentiment – Not Much When Debunked".

Research Software & Digital Projects

† indicates an undergraduate student team member

- I. | **ConvoLab**: Human-AI interaction application designed to let users practice having difficult political conversations with people they disagree with, using two AI agents.
Repository: <https://github.com/GRAIL-center/ConvoLab>. Team: Nebras Alam†, Brinda Akuthota†, Anuj Nair†, Andrew Le Blanc† and Jaskeerat Singh Khosla†

Public Engagement

- I. | **CAPTivated Podcast**, Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University. Released February 5, 2026; new episodes biweekly. Participated in the first season. *Co-founder, Co-host, and Co-producer*.

Fellowships, Grants, and Awards

External

2026	Best Dissertation Award. APSA Information Technology and Politics Section.
2026	Honorable Mention, Thomas E. Patterson Best Dissertation Award. APSA Political Communication Section.
2026	Travel Award to attend APSA. Rapoport Family Foundation. \$1,500
2024	Rapoport Doctoral Dissertation Grant. \$15,000
2024	SPARK Award. APSA Political Communication Section. \$750
2024	Peter Mair Travel Award. APSA European Politics and Society Section. \$300
2024	Prestage-Cook Award. Southern Political Science Association. \$300
2016	Innovation in Development Reporting Grant, European Journalism Centre. Project: The Price of Basmati. €18,510
2012	Language Studies Grant (Arabic, in Cairo), Swedish Journalist Union. \$1,800
2008	Innovation Journalism Fellow, H-STAR Institute, Stanford University (Vinnova)

Selected Internal

2025-2022	Purdue University: Postdoctoral Supplemental Travel Award; Graduate Peer Reviewed Article Award; Graduate Grant Submission Award (multiple years); Promise Travel Grant; Institute for Information Literacy. <i>Total: \$2,500</i>
2024, 2020	Summer Research Grants (Purdue Graduate School, Purdue Research Foundation) <i>Total: \$10,400</i>
2024	Outstanding Teaching Assistant. Departmental award.
2023	Teaching Assistant of the Year. Award by Pi Sigma Alpha, Purdue University

Invited Talks

May 2026	"ConvoLab - building an AI dialogue coaching app". Applied Social Media Lab Forum at the Berkman Klein Center for Internet & Society, Harvard University
February 2026	"Using AI as a Research Assistant". Guest Lecture for COMM 140: Fundamentals of Media Communication, College of Liberal Arts and Sciences at University of Illinois Chicago
February 2026	"Using AI to ask Historical Questions". Workshop with Aaron Mendon-Plasek for the History Department, Purdue University

October 2025	"Navigating Political Violence News in the Digital Age". Center for C-SPAN Scholarship & Engagement (CCSE), Purdue University
October 2025	"Behind the Headlines". Joint seminar presentation with Sage Goodwin. Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University

Conference Presentations

RAD	2026 (poster) Rochester Area Democracy Conference, University of Rochester
SPSA	2026, 2025
PolComm	2026, 2025 APSA Political Communication Preconference
APSA	2026, 2025, 2024, 2023
RMCEPS	2025 (poster) Rebecca B. Morton Conference on Experimental Political Science, New York University
ISA	2025
MPSA	2026, 2025, 2024, 2023, 2022
WPSA	2023
ICTS	2023 International Conspiracy Theory Symposium, University of Miami

Teaching and Research Experience

Instructor of Record

Summer 22/23	POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations
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Research Assistant

AY 2018/19	Editorial Assistant for <i>Politics, Groups, and Identities</i> .
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Teaching Assistant: Graduate level

Fa 24/Sp. 25	SCLA 521 - Societal Impacts of AI
Fa 24/Sp 25	SCLA 522 - Artificial Intelligence Policy, Governance, and Ethics

Teaching Assistant: Undergraduate level

Fa 23, Sp 24	POL 223 - Introduction to Environmental Policy and Politics
Fa 22, Sp 22, Sp 23	POL 327 - Global Green Politics

Fall 2022	POL 323 - Comparative Environmental Policy and Politics
Fall 2021	POL 141 - Introduction to Comparative Politics
Fall 2021	POL 323 - Renewable Energy Politics Around the World
Spring 2021	SCLA 102 - Cornerstone class on Transformative texts, Critical Thinking & Oral Communication II: Modern World “Democracy, Citizenship and Civic Duty”
Fall 2021	SCLA 102 - Cornerstone class on Transformative texts, Critical Thinking and Oral Communication II: “Technology, Great Power, and Its Responsibilities”
Spring 2020	POL 237 - Introduction to U.S. Foreign Policy
Fall 2019	POL 130 - Introduction to International Relations

Selected Additional Training

May, 2026	Summer Institute in Computational Social Sciences <i>University of Rochester, NY</i>
April, 2026	Text Analytics in the Generative AI Era 2.0 <i>Normand Péladeau/Provalis Research, Chicago</i>
January, 2026	AI-Assisted Qualitative Research <i>Trena Paulus/KiND Institute, New Orleans</i>
January, 2026	Experiments in the Social Sciences <i>Donald Green/KiND Institute, New Orleans</i>
September, 2025	Temporal ERGM for Network Panel Data <i>Scott Duxbury, UNC/The Methodology Center at Purdue</i>
April, 2025	Generative AI for Survey Research: Principles and Applications <i>The New York Chapter of the American Association for Public Opinion Research Webinar</i>
April, 2025	Writing Policy Briefs and Op-Eds Communicating Research with Policymakers and Community <i>International Studies Association Webinar</i>
April, 2025	Demystifying the Automated Analysis of Open-Ended Survey Responses <i>American Association for Public Opinion Research Webinar</i>
February, 2025	Supervision in Machine Learning <i>Workshop, Graduate Professional Development, Purdue University</i>
January, 2025	Foundations in Machine Learning <i>KiND Institute/SPSA workshop, Puerto Rico</i>
January, 2025	Data Coding in Qualitative Research <i>KiND Institute/SPSA workshop, Puerto Rico</i>
November, 2024	The AI Imperative: Purdue-Google AI Summit <i>Hyatt Regency, Indianapolis</i>

Fall 2023	Qualitative In-depth Interview Method: A Quality Approach to Data Collection and Analysis Setup <i>American Association for Public Opinion Research Short Course</i>
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Fall 2023	Interpretive Process Tracing & Practice Tracing <i>APSA Short Course</i>
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Pedagogical Training

Summer 2022	Certificate in Foundations of College Teaching <i>Foundations of College Teaching Purdue University</i>
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Languages and Skills

Languages: Swedish and Czech (native); English (fluent); German (intermediate); French and Arabic (basic)

Software: R, Python, Git, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Qualtrics, NVivo, Docker

Learning Management Systems: Blackboard, Brightspace

Service

Department

AY 2023/24 Spring 2025	Political Science Research Collaboratory <i>Mentored undergraduate research assistants on comparative research about media systems, academic writing and survey research. Purdue University</i>
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Committees

2025-2026	Co-Organizer of first Annual “Summit on Information, Technology and American Democracy” <i>Public summit in Indianapolis on April 30th, 2026, organized by CAPT/GRAIL. Gathered thought leaders, educators, policymakers and scholars to discuss the impact of AI and algorithms on our media ecosystem. The event featured an interactive theater performance, moderated panels, community partners and public discussions.</i>
2025-2026	Expert Participant, Information Intelligence Working Group <i>Interdisciplinary development of an "information intelligence" program for youth and civic organizations.</i>

Discipline

2026	MPSA <i>Discussant</i>
2025	Polarization Consortium Workshop <i>Discussant</i>
2025	APSA <i>Chair</i>
2025	SPSA <i>Discussant and Chair</i>
2024	National Institute of Standards and Technology AI Safety Institute Consortium <i>Member of Working Group on Synthetic Content</i>
2023	APSA, MPSA, WPSA <i>Discussant</i>

Relevant Non-academic work experience

Reporter & Staff Writer

2004-2018	Freelance <i>Based in India, Egypt and Silicon Valley. Reporting from 19 countries for over 100 outlets.</i>
Summer 2017	Etc Göteborg <i>Gothenburg, Sweden</i>
Summer 2016	KIT <i>Stockholm, Sweden</i>
Spring 2008	CNET News <i>San Francisco, U.S.</i>
Summer 2007	Dagens Industri <i>Stockholm, Sweden</i>
Summer 2006	Göteborgs-Posten <i>Gothenburg, Sweden</i>
Spring 2006	Veckans Affärer <i>Stockholm, Sweden</i>

Memberships

American Political Science Association, Midwest Political Science Association, Southern Political Science Association

References

Cherie D. Maestas	Associate Dean of Research, Innovation, and Graduate Education, College of Liberal Arts, Professor of Political Science, Purdue University. cmaestas@purdue.edu. Dissertation Chair.
Kathryn Cramer Brownell	Professor in History, and Director of Center for American Political History, Media, and Technology, Purdue University. brownell@purdue.edu. Postdoctoral Supervisor.
Daniel Schiff	Assistant Professor in Political Science and Co-director of Governance and Responsible AI Lab, Purdue University. dschiff@purdue.edu. Postdoctoral Advisor.